CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

PSYCHOLOGIST / THERAPIST IN THE AI ERA

Chatbots can listen at 3 a.m. Therapy is what happens when listening becomes treatment.

★ TL;DR — Licensed therapy and psychology at a ~$105K median, on a 4+ year road of graduate training, supervised hours and a state license. The catch: it's one of the longest pipelines on this site — years of school stand before the independent license. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

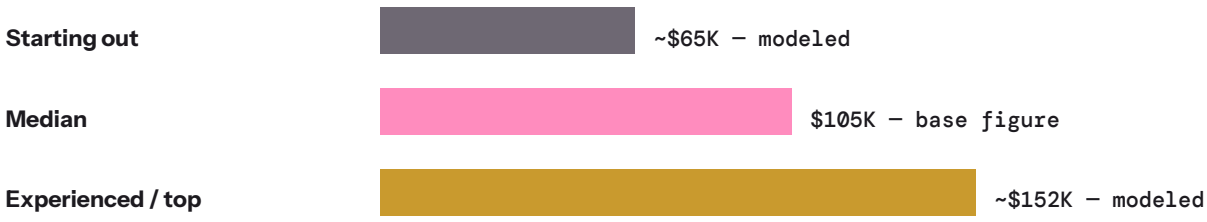
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$105K · TRAINING 4+ years · AI RISK LOW · STATE LICENSE

- Chatbots absorbed casual venting; diagnosis, treatment and accountable care stayed licensed and human.
- The state license is the entire profession: without it you can't practice independently, with it your work is portable.
- The economics reward patience — the median reflects licensed, experienced practitioners, not trainees.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Psychologist / Therapist is a ~$105K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A PSYCHOLOGIST / THERAPIST ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Holding therapy sessions and building treatment plans
- ✓ Assessment, diagnosis and progress evaluation
- ✓ Clinical notes and documentation for every client
- ✓ Consultations, referrals and coordination with other providers

Think: a guide who walks the same trail with different people — and the trail is their inner life.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Session-note drafting, scheduling, screening questionnaires and psychoeducation content are software work. The administrative shell of practice is automating fast.	The therapeutic alliance, clinical judgment and ethical responsibility for real people in real distress. A license means a human answers for the treatment — that accountability is the product.

⚠ **You will spend years and serious tuition becoming licensed while earning little in the field. Plan the money for the long road before you start it.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Deep one-on-one work with visible human change ✓ Autonomy and respect in independent practice ✓ Partly remote-capable once established	✗ Emotional absorption, session after session ✗ Years of training before the real license ✗ Documentation that never fully goes away

Good fit? Patient, perceptive, academically stubborn — and able to fund a long training road. Bad fit? You need earning power soon, or other people's pain stays with you for days.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — THE DOCTORAL ROUTE (PSYCHOLOGIST)	DOOR B — THE MASTER'S ROUTE (LICENSED THERAPIST)
Graduate doctoral training with supervised clinical work, internship and the state psychology license. The longest road, ending at the broadest scope: therapy, assessment and testing under the psychologist title.	A master's in counseling or a related field, followed by supervised post-graduate hours and the state license for that title. Shorter than the doctoral road, focused on therapy practice rather than testing and research.

Smart move: Choose the license before the school. The title you're aiming for decides the degree, the supervised hours and the size of the debt — in that order.
Where you land after: Licensed independent practice, then private-practice ownership or clinical leadership.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
PICK YOUR	PREPARE AND	GRADUATE TRAINING	SUPERVISED PRACTICE	LICENSE EXAMS	PRACTICE INDEPENDENT

STEP 1 — Pick your target license

FREE · TODAY

- Compare the licensed titles in your state: psychologist vs master's-level therapist
- Map each one's degree, supervised hours and exams before choosing a school

STEP 2 — Prepare and apply

MONTHS 1-6

- Close any prerequisite gaps and gather application materials
- Apply to accredited programs that feed your chosen license

STEP 3 — Graduate training

YEARS 1-4+

- Complete coursework in assessment, treatment and ethics
- Accumulate supervised clinical hours in practica and placements

STEP 4 — Supervised practice

POST-DEGREE

- Complete the post-degree supervised hours your license requires
- Work under licensed supervisors in clinics, hospitals or practices

STEP 5 — License exams and application

LICENSE · FINAL STAGE

- Pass the licensing examinations for your title and state
- File with transcripts, hours documentation and clearances

STEP 6 — Practice independently

AFTER LICENSURE

- Join a practice or open your own with systems for notes, billing and boundaries
- Build your specialty and referral network deliberately

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: compare the licensed titles in your state and pick the one you're actually aiming at.

□ Days 1–30: program shortlist built; prerequisite gaps listed honestly.

□ Days 31–60: application materials underway; informational interviews with licensed practitioners done.

□ Days 61–90: applications submitted; financing plan for the long road written down.

□ Day 90: applications are in — the longest pipeline on this site, and you've actually started it.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ THE LICENSE IS THE CAREER. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.